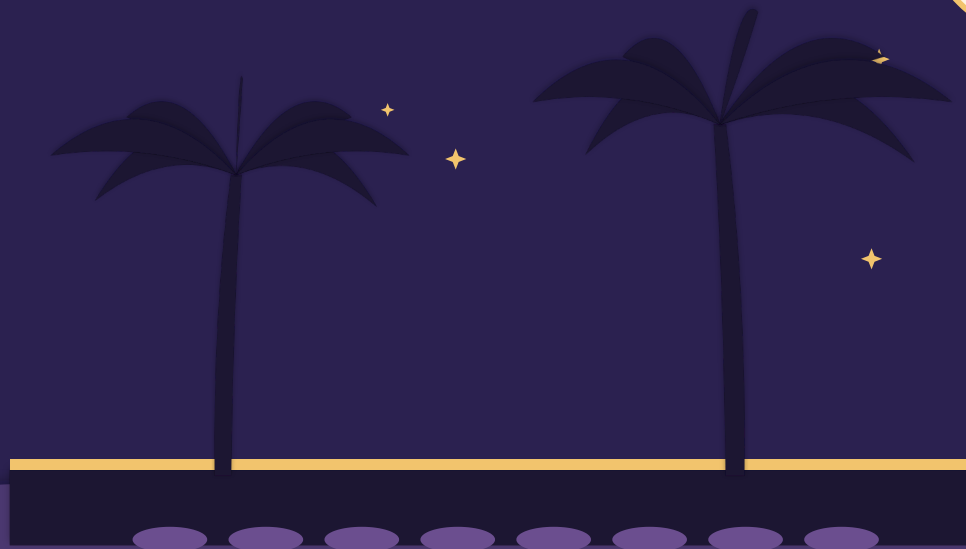


NOOR POST

One of fourteen. Open it on the day.



FOR

[Child's name]



ENVELOPE 09 • SHA'BAN •
INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

🕒 **About twenty-five minutes**

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The prints
- 4 Talk about it
- 5 The stickers
- 6 The postcard

FACT PANEL

Imam Ali Zayn al-Abidin al-Sajjad

(peace be upon him)

B. 38 AH, MEDINA · D. 95 AH, MEDINA

- **Where and when.** Medina, for nearly all of a long life, in a city being watched by a government that had killed his father and did not know what to do with him.
- **Who was ruling.** The Umayyad caliphs from Damascus, and several of them across his lifetime. He outlived the men who ordered Karbala, and the men who came after them, and the men after those.
- **The imamate.** About thirty-four years, from 61 AH, from the age of about twenty-three — beginning on the worst day of his life and lasting longer than most reigns in that empire.
- **What he left.** Two books. *Sahifa Sajjadiyya*, a collection of his prayers, which people have used as their own words for thirteen centuries. And *Risalat al-Huquq* — the Treatise of Rights — the list in this letter, with fifty-one entries.
- **Shahrbanu.** His mother. *Traditionally told: she came from the Persian royal house, and accounts of her origin vary considerably.* What is not disputed is that his line is the point where two very different worlds met in one family.
- **Elsewhere in the world.** In the same years, in China, work began on carving a Buddha out of a cliff face at Leshan — started in 713 CE and not finished for ninety years.

He died in Medina in 95 AH. Shia accounts hold that he was killed on the orders of al-Walid ibn Abd al-Malik.

ENVELOPE 09 · SHA'BAN

The List

● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- After Karbala there was one grown man left in that family, and he was ill on the day it happened, which is the only reason he was not out on that field. He was taken as a prisoner to Kufa, and then to Damascus, and then eventually he was let go, and he went home to Medina.

○ And then what?

- And then, for about thirty-four years, not much anyone could put in a history book. He did not raise an army. He did not make speeches in the market. He mostly prayed, and people who wrote down what he said in his prayers ended up with a book.

○ That's it?

- No. He also did one thing nobody had done in quite that way. He sat down and made a list.

○ A list of what?

- Of every single person and thing you owe something to. Not what you are owed. What you owe. He went through it one by one, and said what each debt was.

- Your tongue is on the list. He says you owe it the duty of keeping it away from what is foul.

○ You can owe your tongue something?

THE LIST • CONTINUED

- And your eyes. And your ears, and your hands, and your feet. Your neighbour is on there. Your teacher is on there. The person you are teaching is on there, separately, with different things owed.
 - Your mother. Your father. Your child — a whole entry about what a parent owes a child, which is not the entry a child expects to find.
- **Is there one for someone who is horrible to you?**
- There is. There is an entry for the person who has wronged you, and it says what you owe them, which is not nothing, and it is the hardest one on the list.
- **Which of these do you owe me? Ask before we go on.**
- And here is what makes it a list and not a sermon. It does not say be good. It says: here is who, here is what, go and do it. Fifty-one entries. You could read the whole thing tonight.
 - Nobody made him write it. He had every reason to be finished with the world.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦
**Everybody you owe.
Written down.**



Then the hadith card.



IMAM AL-SAJJAD SAID



**“The right of the tongue is
that you consider it too noble
for obscenity...”**

Imam al-Sajjad

NOOR POST · THE FOURTEEN

The chain

Every card in this box is one link. Lay all fourteen in order and the chain runs from the Prophet to the last of the twelve, each one passing on what was given.



Fourteen segments · historical order

Risalat al-Huquq, entry 3. Translated by William C. Chittick,
Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Talk about it

About ten minutes. No right answers, and no points.

2

• **Grown-up answers this one first.**

There is an entry for what a parent owes a child. Say one thing you think you owe this child, out loud, now.

3

The hardest entry is the one about a person who has wronged you. What could you possibly owe them?

TURN OVER →

TALK ABOUT IT • CONTINUED

4

He wrote *what you owe*, not *what you are owed*.
Why do you think he did it that way round?

5

🚩 **This one is hard for a grown-up.**

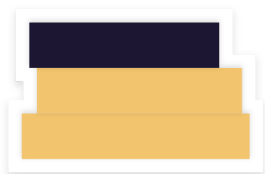
Which entry on that list are you currently not paying?

LAST

Add one entry the list does not have. Both of you write it. Keep it in the box.









We opened this one
together.

● _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

